President H. W. Bush, and Prime Minister Olmert. Israel will strengthen its diplomatic coordination with the United States, and Palestine will enjoy the support of the United States and generous assistance from the moderate Arab states.

The most significant event that took place on the world stage from the end of 2015 until the beginning of 2017 was Donald Trump's election as president of the United States. The Obama doctrine is done, Trump's is still in the making, and there is no certainty that a coherent doctrine will emerge. Judging from the nine months that have passed since Trump entered the White House, the United States is being run with no direction, no staff work, no orderly decision-making process, many scandals, and a president who uses Twitter as his primary tool.

In the new regional political structure, there will be a balance between the United States and Russia, albeit not an entirely symmetrical one but one that is acceptable, provided that Trump, unlike his predecessor Obama, is prepared to invest in shaping the new Middle East. The United States will have a lot of room to maneuver vis-à-vis Russia should it choose to reestablish its presence and influence in the region.

Putin's ultimate goal is to gain American recognition of Russia as a superpower, as it was during the Cold War era. It is hard to predict whether Trump will be willing to grant this to Putin. At least some of Trump's advisers would oppose this and would do everything in their power to dissuade him from doing so. However, even given this situation, there is still a lot of room for negotiation between the United States and Russia on the Middle East following ISIS's obliteration. In order to get Putin to agree to the outline mentioned above, Trump can legitimize Russia's status and influence in a minimized Syria. Putin would consider this a significant reward—Syria as a strategic Russian military base in the Middle East with the possibility of direct access to the Mediterranean Sea. Access to the "warm waters" has been a dream of Russia's since the period of the tsars.

In return for American recognition of Russia's status in Syria, the United States and its allies will demand recognition of their status and influence in independent Kurdistan, independent "Sunnistan," and other pro-Western countries in the Middle East. It would be only natural to give the Sunni community in Iraq its own independent territory, especially given the fact that the Sunnis make up the majority of the land already. "Sunnistan" will enjoy the natural resources on its territory, especially oil